# Testing Feature Branches with Alpha Versions

## Overview

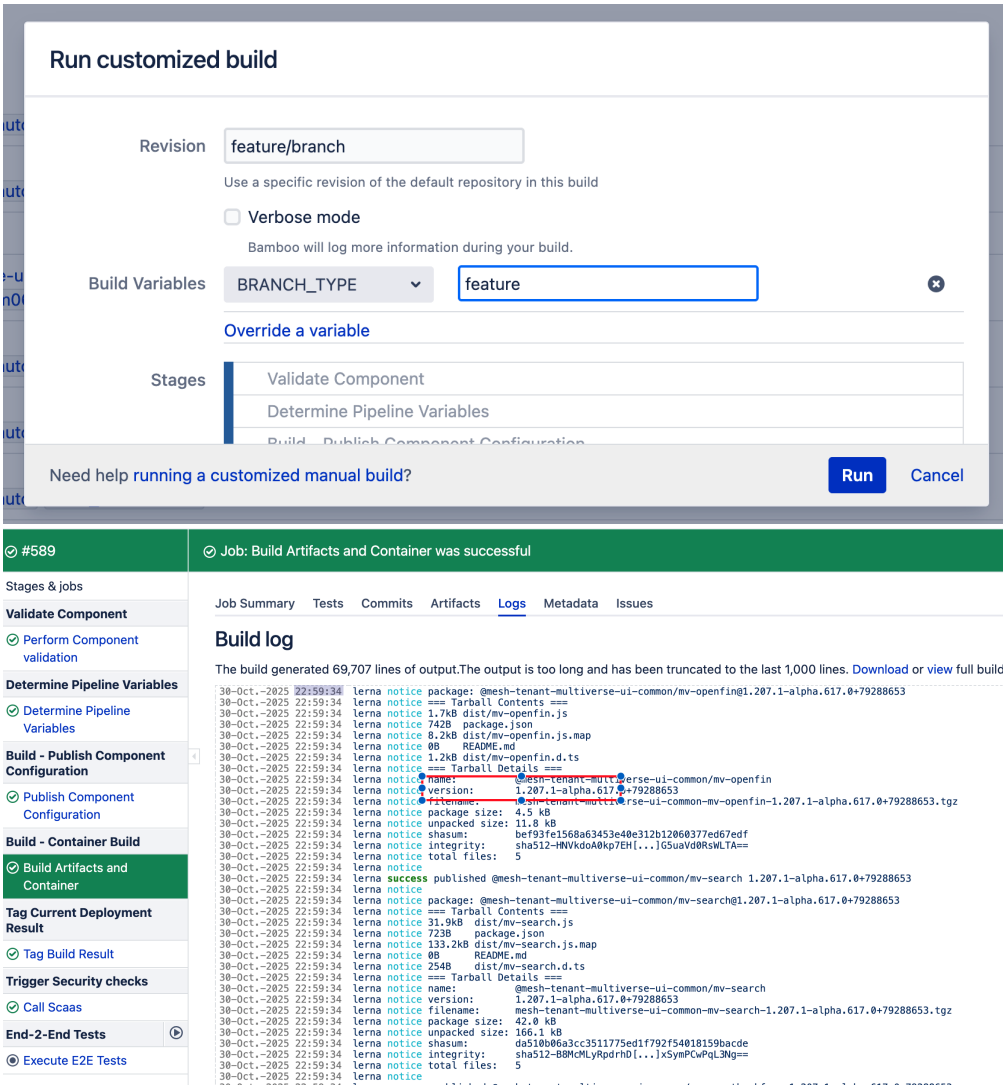
When developing new features in the Multiverse UI Common Library, you can publish alpha versions for testing in Micro Frontend (MFE) apps before merging the feature branch to master. Set the branch_type build variable to feature to trigger the CI pipeline, which generates alpha pre-release versions with unique identifiers.

## Creating Alpha Versions

To create an alpha version:

- Ensure the CI pipeline includes `branch_type=feature` and a branch revision.
- The release process uses **Lerna canary mode** with the naming convention `--preid alpha.${BUILD_NUMBER}` (e.g., `1.184.4-alpha.123.0`).
- Alpha packages are published to the **Westpac Artifactory npm registry** and can be installed via standard `npm` commands.

Access the CI pipeline here: https://bamboo-wdp.srv.westpac.com.au/browse/WDPBUILDLIBRARY-ID20MK




## Integration Testing

After publishing:

- Update your MFE's `package.json` to reference the alpha version (e.g., `"@mesh-tenant-multiverse-ui-common/component-name": "1.184.4-alpha.123.0"`).
- Run `npm install` to fetch the alpha package and test integration.
- **Note:** Alpha versions are temporary and must not be used in production. They are for feature validation before merging to `master`.